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Transcripción de audio

IELTS Academic · Set 13

01 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 1: Inscripción en un gimnasio

Staff: Good afternoon, and welcome to Riverside Gym. How can I help you today?

Customer: Hello. I'd like to sign up for a membership, please.

Staff: Wonderful. Let me take a few details. Can I start with your name?

Customer: Yes, it's Diana Dalton.

Staff: Before we move on to the specific arrangements, I should explain how I handle a gym registration. I will begin with what matters most to you, then compare the practical options, and finally read the record back. That gives us a chance to correct a misunderstanding before anything is confirmed.

Customer: That approach sounds sensible for the gym registration. I made some notes beforehand, although I was not sure whether every detail I found still applied, so I would rather verify it during this conversation.

Staff: Could you spell your surname for me?

Customer: Of course - it's D-A-L-T-O-N.

Staff: Thank you, Diana. And the best contact number for you?

Customer: For this gym registration, I am interested in what will work consistently. I need to understand what the standard arrangement includes and what would count as an optional extra, because changing plans later could be inconvenient.

Staff: Of course. In this gym registration, I will distinguish what is included from what can be added, and you can stop me whenever two alternatives sound too similar.

Customer: My mobile is 077 3352 9041.

Staff: Let me read that back to be sure - 077 3352 9041. Lovely. And your home address?

Customer: I live at 14 Hazelwood Street.

Staff: A gym registration can involve names, dates and choices that are easy to confuse on a first hearing. I will therefore use the full wording and repeat any number in a separate group. Please ask immediately if something conflicts with your notes.

Customer: I will. For the gym registration, accuracy matters more than finishing quickly, especially because I may need to coordinate this with another commitment.

Staff: Great. Now, it helps us if we know your main fitness goal. What are you hoping to achieve?

Customer: Well, at first I thought about weight loss, but what I really want is to improve my stamina.

Staff: Perfect - we can build a programme around that. And how did you hear about us?

Customer: A friend recommended you, actually.

Staff: Let me finish the gym registration by summarising what I have recorded. For this gym registration, I will separate confirmed details from pending ones, spell any unusual word, and explain what happens next. The summary closes the gym registration, so even a minor correction is worth making now.

Customer: Good. During the gym registration, I will listen carefully and confirm each point as you read it.

Staff: That's always nice to hear. Is there anything our trainers should know - any injuries, for example?

Customer: Just my knee. I hurt it last year, so nothing too high-impact.

Staff: Noted - we'll keep your sessions gentle on the knee. And when would you like to begin?

Customer: Before we close the gym registration, could you tell me how I should raise a question after today? I would prefer not to repeat the whole enquiry if one detail changes.

Staff: Certainly. Keep the reference on the confirmation and quote it when you contact us. A colleague can then see the agreed record, identify the single point that needs attention and explain whether the change affects anything else.

Customer: Could I start on Monday?

Staff: Monday's fine. Now let me tell you about our two membership plans. The Standard plan runs on a 12-month contract at £29 a month, and it includes free use of the sauna.

Customer: And the other one?

Staff: Before I close this gym registration, I will separate the details we have confirmed from the points that remain optional. Please listen to the complete summary before responding, because correcting one item can sometimes affect a later choice as well. I will keep the original order so that it is easy to compare with your notes.

Customer: That is helpful. I will check each detail as you read it and ask about anything that does not match what I intended. Once the summary is accurate, I will also note the reference and the method for making a later amendment.

Staff: The Premium plan is more flexible - it's a shorter, 6-month contract, but it costs £45 a month. With Premium you also get a free towel service and two guest passes every month.

Customer: I think the Premium plan sounds better for me.

Staff: A great choice. I'll get the paperwork ready for you now.

02 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 2: Anuncio de orientación en el aeropuerto

Good morning, passengers, and welcome to Kingsford International Airport. My name is Rachel, and I'm one of the terminal's passenger-service officers. Before you continue to the departure gates, I'd like to take a few minutes to explain the facilities and procedures here in the new Terminal Three. Before describing the individual features of this airport orientation, it is useful to understand the overall sequence. The information for the airport orientation follows the order in which most people encounter the site or activity, starting with the shared facilities before turning to optional activities. Knowing that sequence will make the later directions and choices in the airport orientation easier to follow. Let me start with what is available free of charge.

Throughout the terminal you'll find high-speed wireless internet, which is completely free and needs no password. We also run a free shuttle bus between the terminal and the long-stay car park, leaving every ten minutes from Exit B. Please note that our luggage trolleys now require a two-pound refundable deposit, the shower rooms in the lounge cost eight pounds, and left-luggage storage is charged by the hour - so those three are not free. Some arrangements connected with the airport orientation may look familiar while serving a slightly different purpose. During the airport orientation, listen for the difference between a permanent feature and something available only at a stated time.

Where a condition in the airport orientation is fixed, it will be presented as a rule; where there is flexibility, it will be described as a recommendation. As the airport orientation continues, busy points may require visitors to leave additional space. Within the airport orientation, a change to a minor detail does not necessarily alter the main programme. If an alternative becomes necessary during the airport orientation, wait for the full announcement before moving, because the first place mentioned may be the one that is no longer available. Now, some important information about check-in. The check-in desks for international flights are on level two, and they open exactly three hours before departure.

If you're travelling with hand luggage only, you can skip the desks entirely and go straight to security. At security, remember to take any liquids out of your bag - each container must hold no more than 100 millilitres, and all of them must fit inside a single clear plastic bag. Do not try to memorise every detail of the airport orientation at once. Later examples will clarify the distinctions introduced here. For now, concentrate on where the activity begins, which direction or sequence applies, and the point at which you may need to make a choice or ask a member of staff. Once you're through, you'll enter the departure lounge. Boarding information is shown on the large screens, but please don't rely on hearing your name, as we no longer call passengers individually.

Your gate number appears roughly 40 minutes before boarding. If you have time, the duty-free shops are on your left, and a quiet rest area with reclining seats is on the upper floor, right next to the pharmacy. A final way to follow the airport orientation is to separate descriptive information from an instruction that requires action. Background detail explains the setting, while a direct instruction changes what you should do next. Keeping those functions separate will prevent an interesting detail from being mistaken for a change to the programme. If you become uncertain during the

airport orientation, pause at the next staffed point rather than following another group without checking. Explain the last location or instruction you clearly remember, and staff can reconnect you with the correct sequence.

This is especially important when two activities begin near one another or when a temporary diversion changes only one section of the route. The programme is designed to allow questions, so asking for clarification will not make you miss the main activity. Finally, a word about connections. If you're transferring to another flight, follow the purple signs to the transfer desk, where staff will reprint your boarding pass. Passengers with less than one hour between flights should speak to a member of staff at once. Thank you, and enjoy your journey. Before the airport orientation moves to its final practical details, remember that similar locations or services may have different conditions. Listen for the full name, the direction attached to it and any time restriction.

A descriptive example may help you recognise a place, but only a direct instruction tells you to change route or take action. If a temporary arrangement replaces the normal one, the replacement will be stated after the original is identified. This final distinction connects the earlier overview with the choices that follow and helps prevent a familiar name from being confused with the service currently available.

03 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 3: Conversación sobre una tesis de turismo

Tutor: Hi Maya, come in. So, let's talk about your tourism dissertation. Remind me of your main focus.

Maya: Well, originally I wanted to look at the economic impact of tourism, but after doing the reading I decided to focus on how local residents feel about tourism in their town - their attitudes, really.

Tutor: Good - residents' attitudes is a rich area. And why did you choose Whitby as your case study?

Tutor: Before we settle on an interpretation for the tourism dissertation, we should separate what the evidence actually shows from what we expected to find. Our first idea may still help organise the work, but it should not decide how we describe the result.

Maya: Agreed. For the tourism dissertation, we can return to the research question before revising the explanation. That will make the argument more credible.

Maya: Partly because it's beautiful, but mainly because visitor numbers there have grown so fast in the last five years. That rapid growth makes the tensions much easier to see.

Tutor: That makes sense. So how are you collecting your data?

Maya: We also need to be careful about cause and association in the tourism dissertation. Two patterns can occur together without one necessarily producing the other, particularly when the sample is small, participants select themselves, or an uncontrolled factor affects both.

Tutor: Yes. Describing that limitation clearly strengthens the project.

Maya: I did think about interviews, but in the end I'm mainly using a questionnaire, because I wanted responses from a large number of people.

Tutor: A survey is sensible for that. Did you run into any difficulties?

Tutor: Another question is whether our categories for the tourism dissertation are precise enough for somebody else to repeat the procedure. We know what we intended because we designed it, but a reader only has the written definition.

Maya: For the tourism dissertation, let us record the decision rule instead of relying on intuition. That should reveal any ambiguity before the final version.

Maya: The biggest problem was the response rate - a lot of people simply didn't return the form. In the end I only got about a hundred and twenty completed questionnaires.

Tutor: That's still a workable sample. What did the results show?

Maya: The order of the tourism dissertation presentation matters as much as the individual sections. If we give every technical detail before explaining the central question, the audience may lose the thread.

Tutor: For the tourism dissertation, we can rank the evidence by relevance and keep the strongest pattern in the main account.

Maya: The clearest finding was that attitudes depend a lot on age. Younger residents were far more positive, while older ones worried about noise and crowding.

Tutor: Interesting. Now, one suggestion - have you thought about comparing your town with a second location?

Tutor: Our final review of the tourism dissertation should use the agreed criteria rather than simply whether we like the finished version. We need consistent terminology, evidence for each claim and a conclusion that answers the question without exaggeration.

Maya: I will turn those points into a checklist. Then we can assign one person to verify the data and another to test the explanation.

Maya: I hadn't, but that's a good idea.

Tutor: A comparison would really strengthen the analysis. I'd also make sure your literature review covers the idea of 'carrying capacity' - it's central to this debate. And when you write up, keep your methodology chapter detailed, so the whole study could be repeated by someone else.

Maya: We should keep a note of any decision we change during the final review of the tourism dissertation, including the reason for it.

Tutor: Agreed. That record will stop us from reopening settled points without new evidence, and it will show which revision corrected a real weakness rather than merely changing the wording.

Maya: Right. And should I include the raw data?

Tutor: Put the full questionnaire in an appendix, and just summarise the key figures in the main text. Oh, and do get the whole thing proofread before you submit - small errors cost marks.

Tutor: Before we finish the tourism dissertation, let us read the argument from the perspective of somebody who did not collect the evidence. Each claim should identify what was observed, how it was measured and which limitation affects the interpretation.

Maya: I will also check that our recommendation follows from the result rather than from what we expected at the beginning. If a sentence sounds stronger than the method allows, we can narrow it without losing the main point.

Tutor: Good. Then the final version will show a clear line from the research question through the evidence to the conclusion.

Maya: Great, that's really helpful. Thank you.

04 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 4: Investigación en la Antártida

Good morning. Today's lecture is about scientific research in Antarctica, the coldest, windiest and driest continent on Earth. Although it has no permanent human population, at any one time during the summer season around 5,000 scientists and support staff live and work there. To place the Antarctic-research lecture in perspective, we need to distinguish the familiar modern description from the longer process that produced it. Within the Antarctic-research lecture, what now appears stable often emerged through competing explanations that were tested under different conditions. A simple list of events in the Antarctic-research lecture can hide those alternatives, so the discussion will emphasise why particular changes mattered. Let me begin with why Antarctica matters to science. First, it is the finest place on the planet to study the history of our climate. Deep in the ice sheet, layers of compressed snow have trapped tiny bubbles of ancient air. By drilling out long cylinders of ice, called cores, researchers can measure the make-up of the atmosphere going back almost a million years. This makes the ice a unique climate archive. Evidence for the Antarctic-research lecture does not come from a single source. Researchers may compare physical traces, written records, measurements and observations. Each source answers a different question and carries its own uncertainty. Agreement can increase confidence, while disagreement often reveals an assumption or a measurement problem that deserves closer examination. Antarctica is also central to studying the oceans.

The cold, dense water that forms around the continent sinks and drives the global system of ocean currents, a process that helps to regulate temperatures worldwide. And the surrounding Southern Ocean is extraordinarily rich in a small, shrimp-like creature called krill, which sits at the very base of the food chain. Scale is especially important when evaluating the Antarctic-research lecture. A process observed in one case, one community or one short trial may behave differently across a region or over several generations. In this Antarctic-research lecture, changes in measurement must not be confused with changes in reality. This comparison helps identify which conditions are essential and which are merely helpful. The continent is important for space science too.

The thin, dry, stable air makes it an excellent site for telescopes, and the deep ice is even used to detect particles arriving from distant galaxies. Meteorites are also far easier to find here, because dark rocks stand out so clearly against the white surface. It is also worth noticing the language of certainty used in the Antarctic-research lecture. Some mechanisms are supported by direct observation, while others remain the best explanation available from indirect evidence. Uncertainty can be described without abandoning a well-supported explanation. Keep that distinction in mind as the examples are brought together.

The separate examples in the Antarctic-research lecture can finally be organised around three questions: what conditions begin a change, which mechanisms sustain it, and what consequences appear later. For the Antarctic-research lecture, the framework is useful only if exceptions and limits remain visible. The conclusion to the Antarctic-research lecture will use that framework to connect the details without extending them beyond the available evidence. Of course, working in Antarctica is difficult. The extreme cold is an obvious hazard, but the biggest practical problem for researchers is often the isolation, especially through the long, dark winter. Supplies must arrive before the sea

freezes, and once winter begins, no aircraft can land.

A useful final check is to ask what observation would make the present account of the Antarctic-research lecture less convincing. Identifying such evidence keeps the explanation testable and reveals where future research would be most informative. It also prevents a plausible narrative from being treated as complete merely because its separate examples fit together. Finally, a word about protection. Since 1959, the continent has been governed by an international treaty that sets the whole area aside for peaceful, scientific use. Scientists today are particularly worried about the stability of the ice, because its melting would raise global sea levels dramatically. Continued monitoring, therefore, remains absolutely essential.

One final point about the Antarctic-research lecture concerns the difference between a useful model and a complete explanation. A model selects the relationships that matter most for a particular question, so it can be informative even when it leaves out local variation. Problems arise when that simplification is forgotten and a result from one scale is treated as a rule for every case. The evidence discussed here should therefore be read with its conditions attached: the period observed, the population or material studied, the method used and the uncertainty that remains. Those conditions do not weaken the account; they show exactly where the conclusion is supported and where further observation would be needed.